UNIT 42.4 · LEVEL C1

Distancing

50 questions · 6 parts

Date: _____ Score: _____ / 50

When you finish, check the Answer Key at the end of this unit.

Part A · Multiple Choice (questions 1–10)

Circle the letter of the correct answer.

1 The company is _____ to be planning layoffs.

a) told **b)** asked **c)** said **d)** spoken

2 _____ , the road will reopen in May.

a) According to officials **b)** According officials
c) Accord to officials **d)** Accordingly officials

3 The thief _____ entered through a window.

a) certainly **b)** definitely **c)** clearly **d)** allegedly

4 It _____ that the meeting has been cancelled.

a) looks **b)** appears **c)** feels **d)** resembles

5 He is _____ to have won a fortune.

a) asked **b)** reported **c)** reminded **d)** advised

6 The _____ 'genius' made a basic error.

a) real **b)** true **c)** proven **d)** so-called

7 The painting is _____ a lost Picasso.

a) supposedly **b)** obviously **c)** proudly **d)** recently

8 Which sentence distances the speaker from the claim?

a) The bank closed.
b) The bank is closed.
c) The bank is reported to have closed.
d) The bank has closed.

9 She _____ to be fluent in four languages.

a) asks **b)** allows **c)** persuades **d)** claims

10 _____ rumours, the singer is retiring.

a) According to **b)** Because of **c)** In spite of **d)** Instead of

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Part B · Fill in the Gaps (questions 11–20)

Write the missing word in each blank.

11 The film is _____ to be a masterpiece.

12 He _____ to be annoyed by the news.

13 _____ , she left without saying goodbye.

14 The man is _____ to have escaped by boat.

15 It _____ that the system was hacked.

16 The company _____ to have lost millions.

17 They _____ to be experts, but they aren't.

18 The _____ expert never replied.

19 The plan was _____ approved last week.

20 There _____ to be a problem with the engine.

Part C · Unscramble the Words (questions 21–28)

Put the words in the correct order to make a sentence. Write it on the line. Remember the capital letter and the full stop.

21 **said / is / be / to / he / rich / very**

_____

22 **appears / to / the / have / failed / plan**

_____

23 **according / to / the / police / thief / the / escaped**

_____

24 **so-called / friend / his / lied / to / him**

_____

25 **seems / there / to / a / be / problem**

_____

26 **allegedly / he / the / stole / car**

_____

27 **thought / to / is / be / dangerous / the / road**

_____

28 **claims / to / know / she / everyone**

_____

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Part D · Choose and Complete (questions 29–35)

Choose the correct option and write it in the blank.

29 *Choose the best option.*
The minister _____ to have resigned.
Options: **is told** / **is said** / **is asked** / **is made**

30 *Choose the best option.*
The company _____ made a huge profit.
Options: **hardly** / **never** / **allegedly** / **carefully**

31 *Choose the best option.*
It _____ that the train is late.
Options: **wishes** / **allows** / **appears** / **teaches**

32 *Choose the best option.*
The _____ witness never called back.
Options: **so-said** / **so-called** / **so-known** / **so-claim**

33 *Choose the best option.*
They are _____ to be the oldest couple in town.
Options: **wished** / **waited** / **helped** / **believed**

34 *Choose the best option.*
_____ , the meeting was cancelled.
Options: **Because of staff** / **Thanks staff** / **According to staff** / **Instead staff**

35 *Choose the best option.*
He _____ to be a doctor, but he isn't.
Options: **claims** / **allows** / **makes** / **helps**

Part E · Matching (questions 36–40)

Match the items. Write the correct letter next to each number.

36 Match each word to its use.

1. allegedly _____	**A.** based on what seems true
2. apparently _____	**B.** believed, but doubted
3. reportedly _____	**C.** claimed but not proven
4. supposedly _____	**D.** according to what others say

37 Match each phrase to its meaning.

1. is said to _____	**A.** says without proof
2. seems to _____	**B.** others say so
3. so-called _____	**C.** it looks that way
4. claims to _____	**D.** I doubt the label

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38 Match each fact to a distanced version.

1. She won _____
2. They left _____
3. It broke _____
4. He lied _____

A. He is alleged to have lied
B. It appears to have broken
C. They are reported to have left
D. She is said to have won

39 Match the phrase to its tone.

1. according to police _____
2. rumour has it _____
3. it is widely believed _____
4. some critics say _____

A. informal and doubtful
B. general opinion
C. unnamed group
D. names a source

40 Match the word to its type.

1. allegedly _____
2. alleged _____
3. allege _____
4. allegation _____

A. verb
B. adverb
C. noun
D. adjective

Part F · Find the Error (questions 41–50)

Each sentence has one mistake. Underline it and write the correct word.

41 He said to be the best player. Correct word: _____

42 It seems that he having left already. Correct word: _____

43 The plan seems working well. Correct word: _____

44 According of the report, sales fell. Correct word: _____

45 The painting is claimed being a forgery. Correct word: _____

46 He is believed living abroad. Correct word: _____

47 The so-called experts agrees on nothing. Correct word: _____

48 Supposed, the shop closes at nine. Correct word: _____

49 It is reported what the minister has resigned.
Correct word: _____

50 It seems that she don't know. Correct word: _____

Your score

Count one point for each correct answer. Below 70%? Review the topic and try the unit again in a few days.

A	B	C	D	E	F	Total
____ / 10	____ / 10	____ / 8	____ / 7	____ / 5	____ / 10	____ **/ 50**

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Answer Key

Distancing

Part A · Multiple Choice

1	**c)** said	Be said to + infinitive distances the speaker.
2	**a)** According to officials	According to names a source.
3	**d)** allegedly	Allegedly means claimed but not proven.
4	**b)** appears	It appears that + clause.
5	**b)** reported	Be reported to have + past participle.
6	**d)** so-called	So-called shows doubt about a label.
7	**a)** supposedly	Supposedly shows doubt.
8	**c)** The bank is reported to have closed.	Reported to shows a second-hand source.
9	**d)** claims	Claim to be signals possible doubt.
10	**a)** According to	According to + source.

Part B · Fill in the Gaps

11	**said** (or: thought, believed, reported, claimed)	Be said to + infinitive distances the speaker.
12	**seemed** (or: appeared)	Seem + to-infinitive softens a claim.
13	**Apparently** (or: Reportedly, Supposedly)	Apparently shows indirect evidence.
14	**alleged** (or: reported, said, believed)	Alleged means claimed without proof.
15	**appears** (or: seems)	It appears that + clause.
16	**is said** (or: is reported, is believed, is thought)	Be said to have + past participle.
17	**claim** (or: pretend, purport)	Claim to be implies doubt.
18	**so-called** (or: self-styled, supposed)	So-called shows doubt about a label.
19	**reportedly** (or: allegedly, supposedly)	Reportedly shows a second-hand source.
20	**seems** (or: appears)	There seems to be…

Part C · Unscramble the Words

21	**He is said to be very rich.**	Be said to + infinitive.
22	**The plan appears to have failed.**	Appear + perfect infinitive.
23	**According to the police, the thief escaped.**	According to + source.
24	**His so-called friend lied to him.**	So-called + noun.

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25	**There seems to be a problem.**	There seems to be.
26	**He allegedly stole the car.**	Adverb before the verb.
27	**The road is thought to be dangerous.**	Be thought to + infinitive.
28	**She claims to know everyone.**	Claim + to-infinitive.

Part D · Choose and Complete

29	**is said**	Be said to have.
30	**allegedly**	Allegedly distances the speaker.
31	**appears**	It appears that.
32	**so-called**	So-called shows doubt.
33	**believed**	Be believed to be.
34	**According to staff**	Names a source.
35	**claims**	Claim to be implies doubt.

Part E · Matching

36	**1-C 2-A 3-D 4-B**	allegedly – claimed but not proven; apparently – based on what seems true; reportedly – according to what others say; supposedly – believed, but doubted Think about the source of the claim.
37	**1-B 2-C 3-D 4-A**	is said to – others say so; seems to – it looks that way; so-called – I doubt the label; claims to – says without proof Each phrase distances the speaker.
38	**1-D 2-C 3-B 4-A**	She won – She is said to have won; They left – They are reported to have left; It broke – It appears to have broken; He lied – He is alleged to have lied Add a distancing structure.
39	**1-D 2-A 3-B 4-C**	according to police – names a source; rumour has it – informal and doubtful; it is widely believed – general opinion; some critics say – unnamed group Think about the source.
40	**1-B 2-D 3-A 4-C**	allegedly – adverb; alleged – adjective; allege – verb; allegation – noun Check the word endings.

Part F · Find the Error

41	**is said**	Be said to + infinitive.
42	**has**	It seems that + full clause.
43	**to be working** (or: to work)	Seem + to-infinitive.
44	**to**	Use according to.
45	**to be**	Be claimed + to-infinitive.
46	**to live**	Be believed + to-infinitive.
47	**agree**	Plural subject takes agree.
48	**Supposedly**	Use the adverb form.
49	**that**	Use that after reported.
50	**doesn't** (or: does not)	Third person singular.

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